Nudge onboarding

Product spec and screen-by-screen walkthrough. Prototype status as of November 2026.

Overview

Onboarding runs once, right after a new account is created with email or Google. The demo account and returning log-ins skip it. It has three short steps and takes under a minute.

The goal: a new user should finish onboarding with their real applications already on the dashboard, and ideally with a follow-up already flagged. An empty dashboard is the weakest first impression a dashboard product can make.

Principles

- **Only ask what changes the first screen.** Everything else is asked later, at the moment it's useful.
- **Every step can be skipped.** Continue works with nothing filled in, and Skip setup exits at any point.
- **Nothing is added without approval.** Jobs found from emails or links go into a review list first.
- **No sensitive data at sign-up.** No salary, demographics, or GPA, and no inbox access.

Layout

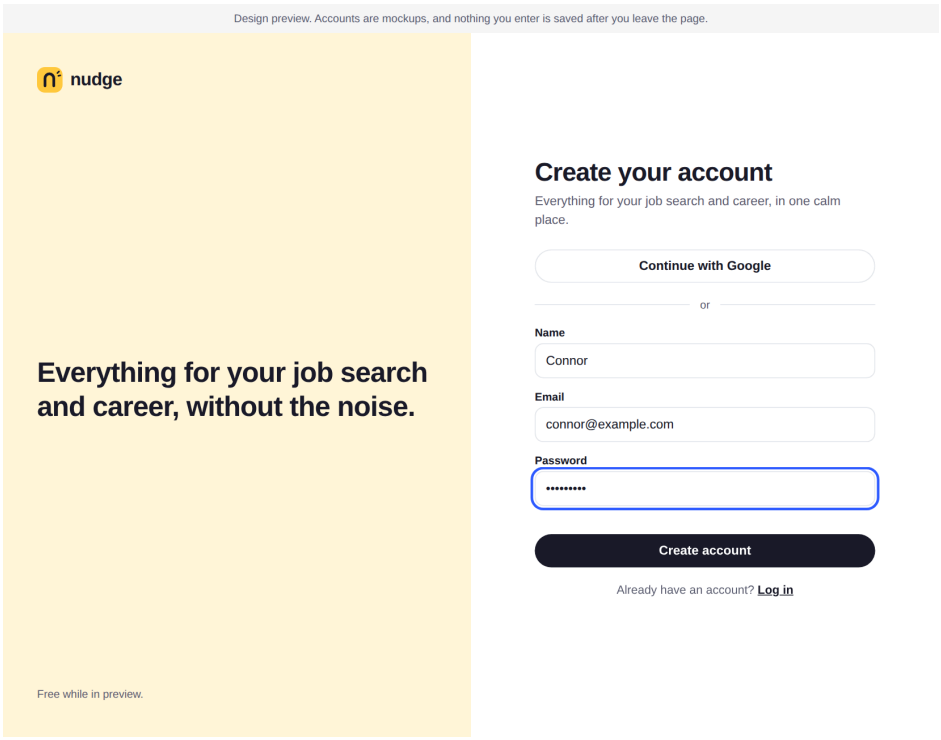
Logo at top left, a three-part progress bar in the center, and Skip setup at top right. Back and Continue stay pinned to the bottom of the screen. Back is hidden on step 1.

What onboarding collects

- **Sign-up:** first name, email, and password.
- **Step 1:** where the person is in their search, plus an optional question about how they've tracked their search so far.
- **Step 2:** up to 3 target roles, location and remote preference, job type, and start timing.
- **Step 3:** their existing applications, by forwarding emails, pasting links, or adding by hand.

Screen by screen

Screen 1: Sign up

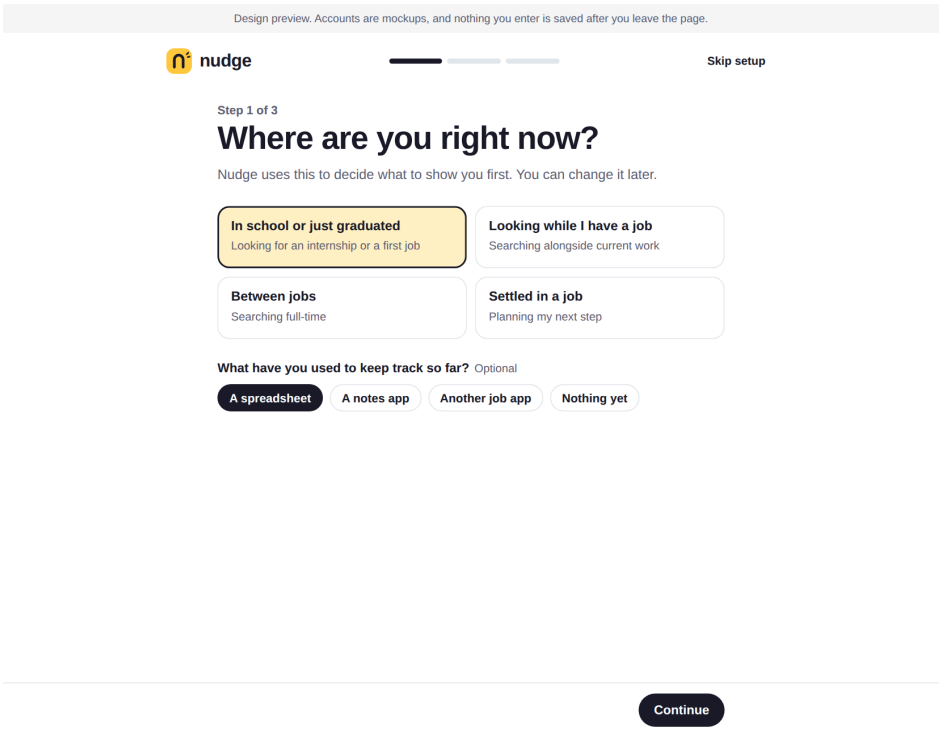


Sign-up asks for name, email, and password only.

The account form. Continue with Google is offered above the form. Submitting the form or choosing Google opens onboarding step 1.

- **Collects:** name, email, password.
- **Note:** the page copy still says “one calm place” and should be updated to the new positioning.

Screen 2: Where are you right now?



Step 1 with an option selected.

Subtext: Nudge uses this to decide what to show you first. You can change it later.

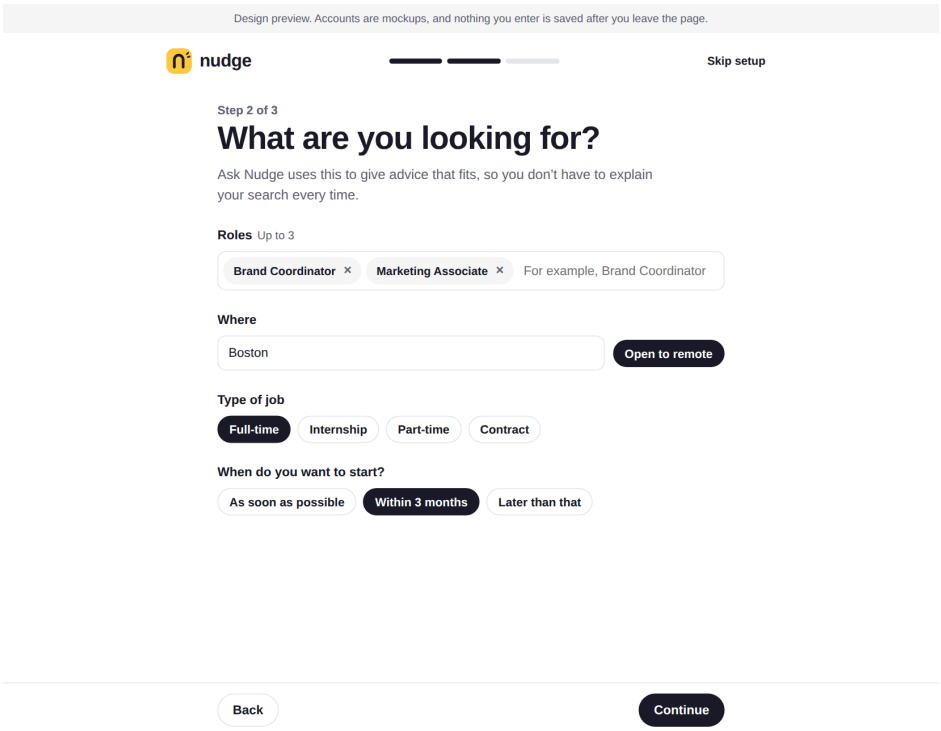
Four choices, pick one:

- **In school or just graduated:** looking for an internship or a first job
- **Looking while I have a job:** searching alongside current work
- **Between jobs:** searching full-time
- **Settled in a job:** planning my next step

Optional question: What have you used to keep track so far? A spreadsheet, a notes app, another job app, or nothing yet.

What it changes: choosing Settled in a job adjusts the wording of steps 2 and 3 and lands the person on Career instead of Today. The tracking question is user research data and doesn't change the app.

Screen 3: What are you looking for?



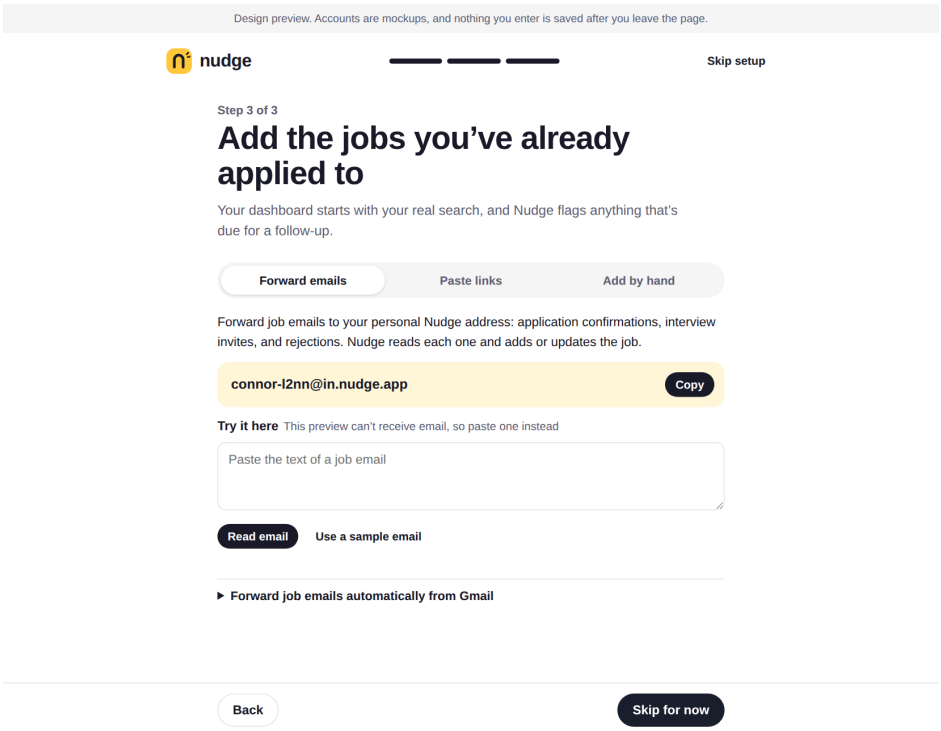
Step 2 filled in.

Subtext: Ask Nudge uses this to give advice that fits, so you don't have to explain your search every time. For settled users, the heading reads "What role do you want next?"

1. **Roles:** up to 3, typed in and added as tags with Enter or a comma.
2. **Where:** a city or region, plus an Open to remote toggle.
3. **Type of job:** Full-time, Internship, Part-time, or Contract. Pick any.
4. **Start timing:** As soon as possible, Within 3 months, or Later than that.

What it changes: the answers are passed to Ask Nudge as context, and they'll power job matching later. For settled users, the first role fills in "Where you want to be next" on the Career page.

Screen 4: Add your jobs: forward emails



Step 3 opens on the Forward emails tab.

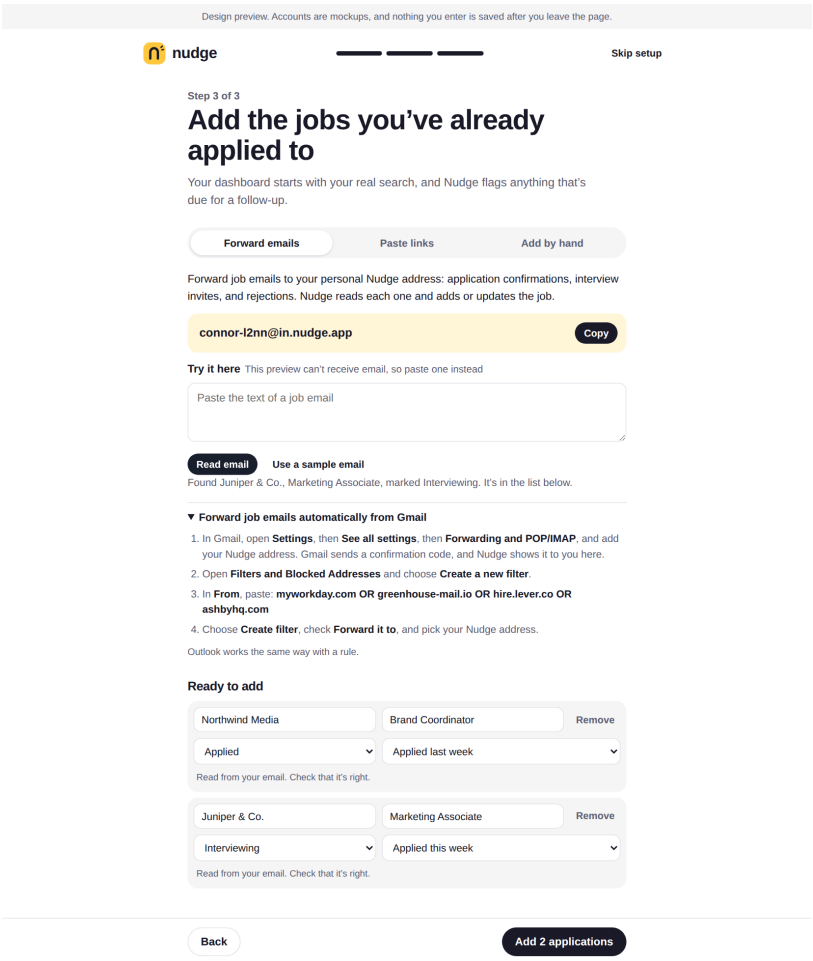
Heading: Add the jobs you've already applied to.

Subtext: Your dashboard starts with your real search, and Nudge flags anything that's due for a follow-up. Settled users see: If you're not applying anywhere right now, skip this step.

Three tabs: Forward emails (default), Paste links, and Add by hand.

- Shows the person's unique forwarding address, such as connor-7k2m@in.nudge.app, with a Copy button.
- Explains what to forward: application confirmations, interview invites, and rejections.
- In the prototype only, a Try it here box lets the person paste an email, since the prototype can't receive real email. A sample email is available for demos.

Screen 5: After reading an email



Two emails read, with the Gmail guide expanded.

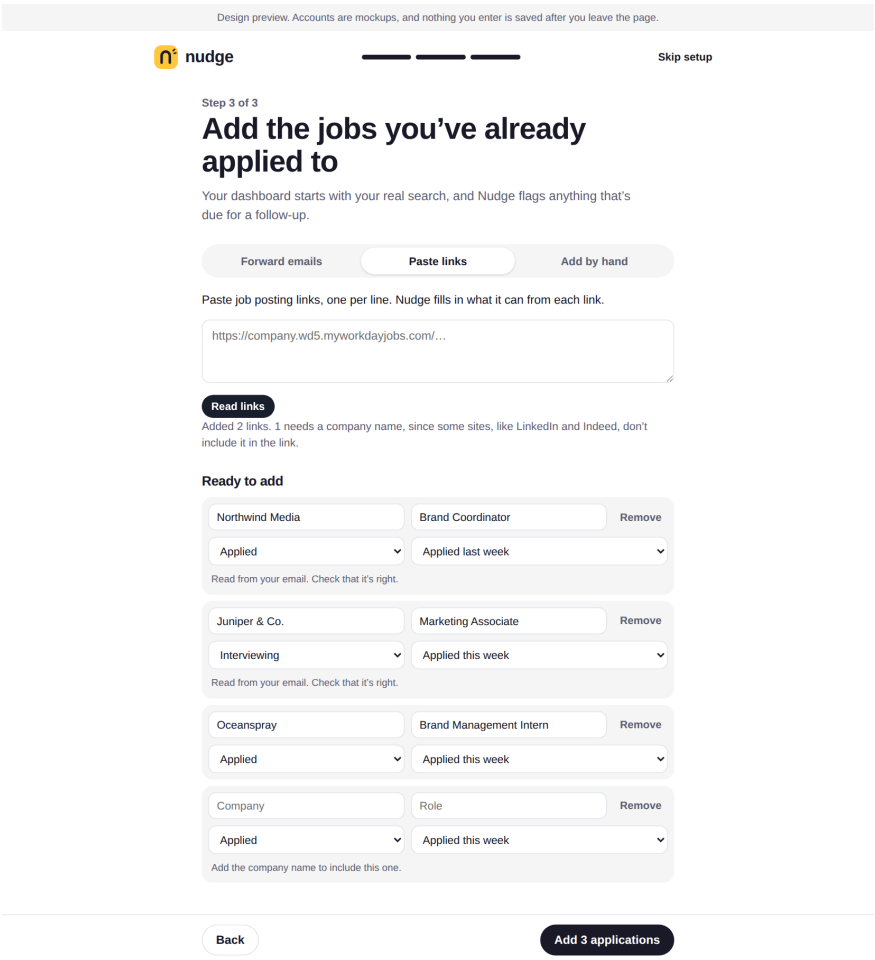
- Each email Nudge reads becomes a job in the Ready to add list, marked “Read from your email. Check that it’s right.”
- If a later email is from a company already in the list, Nudge updates that job’s status instead of adding a duplicate. For example, a rejection email moves a job from Applied to Rejected.
- Emails are read by sender and wording rules first. The real build adds an AI fallback for emails the rules can’t read.

Gmail auto-forward guide (collapsed by default):

1. Add the Nudge address in Gmail’s forwarding settings. Gmail sends a confirmation code, and Nudge shows it to the person.
2. Create a new filter.
3. Filter for emails from hiring systems such as Workday, Greenhouse, Lever, and Ashby.
4. Forward matching emails to the Nudge address.

Outlook works the same way with a rule.

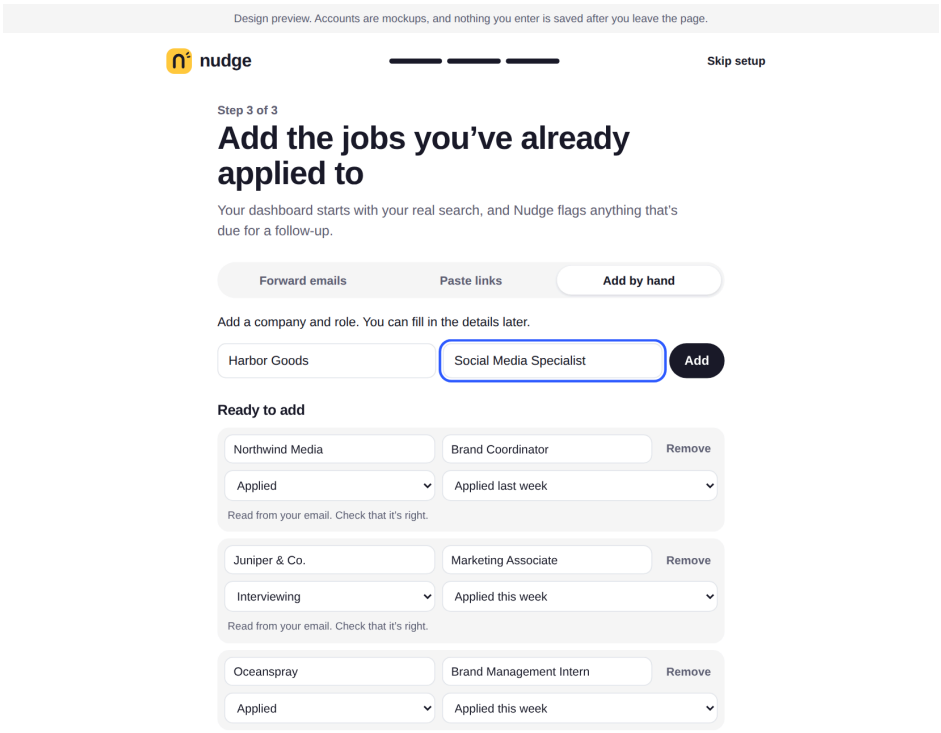
Screen 6: Add your jobs: paste links



Two links read, one missing a company name.

- Paste one or more job links, one per line.
- Nudge fills in the company, role, and location where the link includes them. This works fully for Workday and gives the company only for Greenhouse, Lever, and Ashby.
- Links without a company name, such as LinkedIn and Indeed, are added with a note asking the person to fill it in.
- Company names read from links can run together, like “Oceanspray,” so the person should check them.

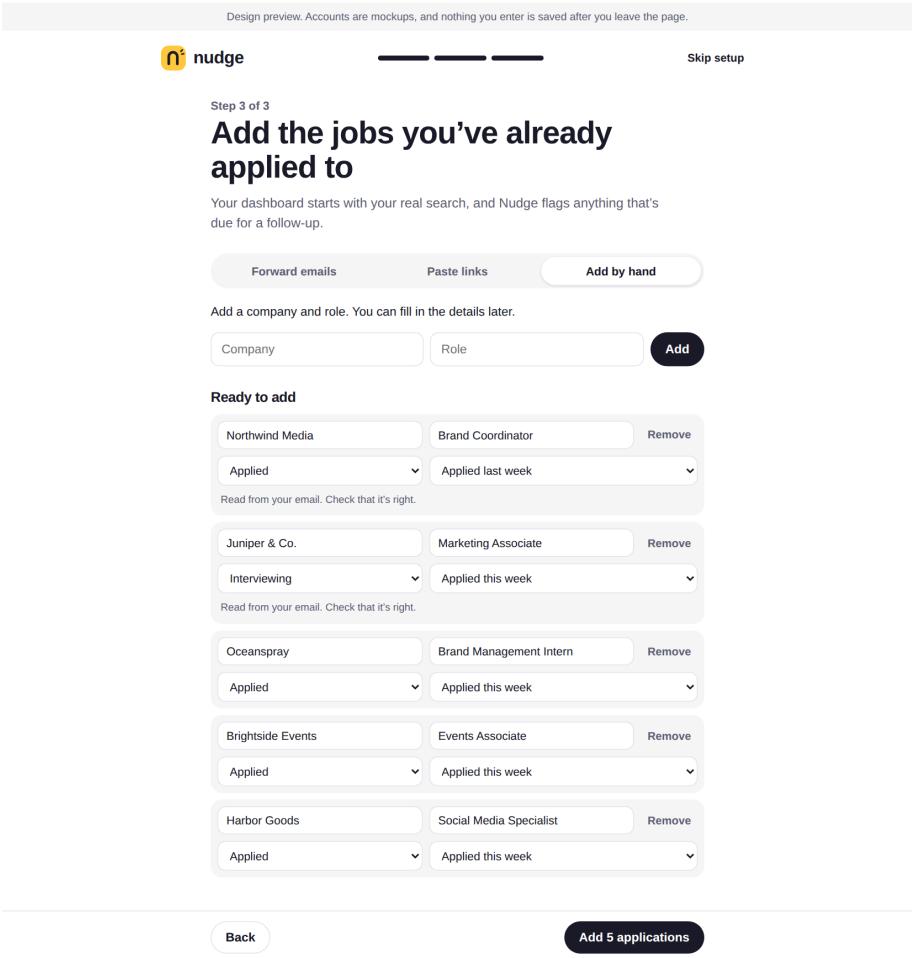
Screen 7: Add your jobs: add by hand



Manual entry asks for company and role only.

- Company and role, then Add. Enter in the company field moves to role, and Enter in role adds the job.
- Status and date can be adjusted in the list below.

Screen 8: Ready to add



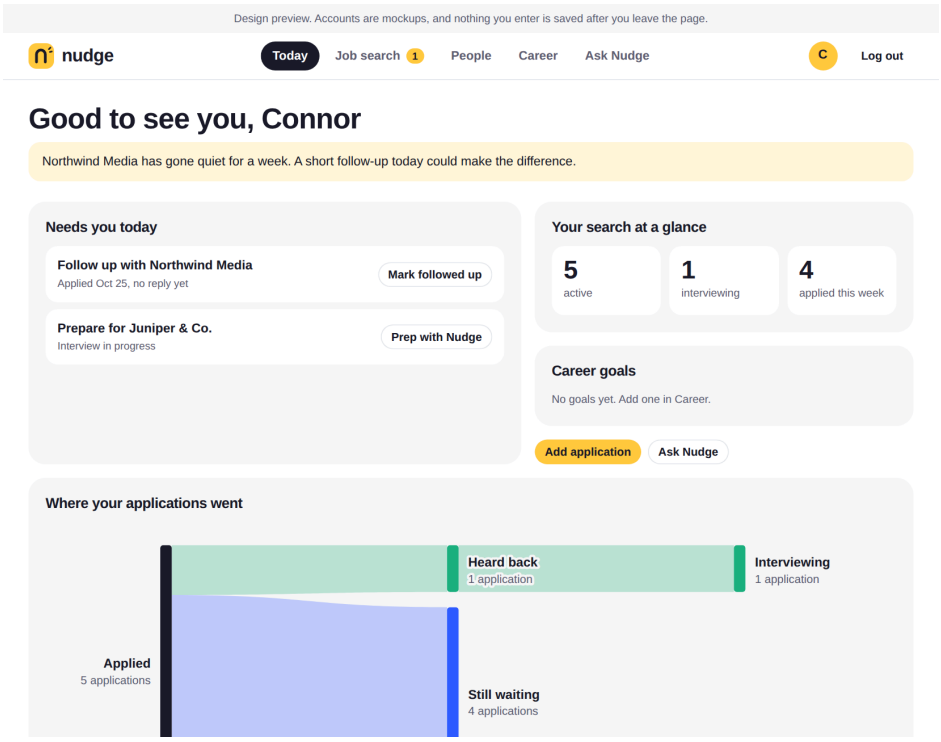
The review list, combining all three methods.

Appears as soon as anything is added. Each job shows:

- Editable company and role.
- Status: Applied, Interviewing, Offer, Rejected, or Not applied yet.
- Roughly when they applied: this week, last week, or earlier. Hidden for Not applied yet.
- Remove.

Jobs without a company name are flagged and left out until one is added. The finish button shows the count, such as “Add 5 applications,” or reads “Skip for now” when the list is empty. Nothing is saved until the person presses it.

Screen 9: Landing on Today



The first dashboard view, already populated.

- The person lands on Today, or on Career if they chose Settled in a job and added no applications.
- Any job marked Applied last week or earlier is already flagged as needing a follow-up, so Today has something to act on immediately.
- If nothing was added, Today's welcome message points to adding a first application. Settled users are pointed to setting a goal in Career.

Intentionally left out

- **Resume upload.** A later addition to step 2 that pre-fills answers, once the backend can read resumes. It adds AI cost per upload and means storing personal information from the first minute.
- **Connecting an inbox directly.** Gmail inbox access needs Google verification and an annual security assessment. Forwarding replaces it for now.
- **Salary, demographics, and GPA.** Not needed by the dashboard, and they raise the privacy stakes.
- **LinkedIn import.** LinkedIn offers no public access for this.

Open items for the backend

- **Inbound email.** A service such as Postmark, SendGrid, or Mailgun to receive mail at a domain Nudge owns.
- **Unique addresses.** One random address per user, so others can't guess it or add items to someone's account.
- **Gmail confirmation codes.** Catch Gmail's forwarding confirmation email and show the code to the user, or auto-forward setup stalls.
- **Sender list.** Confirm the actual sender addresses for Workday, Greenhouse, Lever, and Ashby against real emails before publishing the filter guide.
- **Data handling.** Store only the extracted company, role, status, and date, and delete the original email after a short window. The privacy policy should say so.
- **Spam.** Ignore anything sent to a forwarding address that isn't clearly a job email.